

WordPress's official account faces criticism for mocking the FAIR decentralisation project

An official WordPress.org X (formerly Twitter) account has sparked backlash across the open source community after posting a mocking, sarcastic comment targeting the FAIR (Federated And Independent Repositories) Project, an open source initiative focused on decentralising WordPress plugin and theme distribution.

The post was widely condemned by developers and contributors as “childish,” “unprofessional,” and “undignified,” with many arguing that the tone was inappropriate for an official channel representing one of the world’s largest open source platforms. Several critical responses were later hidden by WordPress.

FAIR was launched in 2025 to address risks associated with centralised control over WordPress software distribution. The project aims to prevent any single individual or organisation from disrupting the free distribution of WordPress software by establishing a vendor-neutral, federated infrastructure.

FAIR has received backing from the Linux Foundation, which stated in June 2025 that vendor-neutral package management is critical infrastructure for modern content, e-commerce, and AI-driven systems, promoting innovation and protecting business continuity.

Community figures, including SEO consultant Jono Alderson, criticised the official WordPress account’s conduct, warning that such behaviour undermines trust, damages the WordPress brand, and runs counter to open source values of professionalism, neutrality, and inclusivity.

Richard Morton, executive director at MBZUAI’s Institute of Foundation Models, said, “NANDA marks an important milestone in bringing high-quality, open-access language technology to one of the world’s largest linguistic communities.”

India denies mandatory smartphone source code access

India does not mandate smartphone manufacturers to share their source code with the government, industry bodies and official sources have clarified, countering a *Reuters* report that suggested authorities were considering compulsory access to proprietary software.

Industry analysts say any such requirement would face strong resistance from global smartphone OEMs due to intellectual property and governance risks. “OEMs (original equipment manufacturers) like Apple and Samsung reject source code disclosure over IP (intellectual property) risks and absent global precedents,” said Prabhu Ram, vice-president at CyberMedia Research. No country currently mandates full source code disclosure for smartphone security audits, reinforcing the



global reluctance around such measures.

Analysts also note that India lacks the statutory authority to compel proprietary operating system or source code handovers. Apple’s earlier refusal to

provide its source code to Chinese authorities is frequently cited as a benchmark case. As a result, any regulatory move is expected to end in compromise rather than enforcement.

Security concerns underpinning the debate include rising cyber fraud, IMEI cloning, and systemic vulnerabilities in India’s smartphone-first economy. Analysts caution that enforced compliance would disproportionately impact mass-market Android manufacturers, potentially leading to slower updates or higher device costs for consumers.

Google launches Universal Commerce Protocol to power agentic AI commerce

Google has introduced the Universal Commerce Protocol (UCP), a new open standard that enables AI agents to autonomously perform end-to-end commerce activities, spanning product discovery, purchasing, checkout, payments, and post-purchase experiences.

Released under the Apache 2 open source licence, UCP is positioned as an openly governed, interoperable framework rather than a proprietary commerce system. Google says the protocol defines the foundational “building blocks for agentic commerce,” allowing AI-driven shopping experiences to operate across platforms without bespoke integrations.

Describing UCP as the “core plumbing for agentic commerce,” Google aims to standardise how AI agents, retailers, platforms, and payment providers transact through a single shared protocol. The company says this approach removes the need for fragmented, custom-built connections that currently slow down digital commerce.

“UCP establishes a common language for agents and systems to operate together across consumer surfaces, businesses and payment providers,” wrote Vidhya Srinivasan, VP & GM for Ads & Commerce at Google, adding that the